

RE: PROGRAM MANAGER — TECHSTARS BOULDER

Hi Techstars Boulder team,

I'm writing to apply for the Program Manager role. I'm a Boulder-based co-founder, ten minutes from your office, and I sit at an unusual intersection: **I'm currently a founder going through an accelerator** (Upstream AI is in **Startup Colorado's Founder Cooperative + Growth Accelerator** right now), and I've spent **fifteen years running programs and operations at startups** before this. Both halves matter for the PM seat.

Three things stand out:

- 1 Founder right now.** I know what a founder needs from a PM because I'd want it from mine. Calendar protection, mentor matches that actually help, a PM who anticipates the next blocker before it's a fire. I'm getting it (and noticing where it's missing) at Startup Colorado this minute.
- 2 15 years of program ops.** Solutions Engineering Mgr at Homebot (early team, through their fundraise + acquisition). Head of Marketing Tech at Teren (seed-stage geospatial, 4x MQLs MoM). Marketing Automation Mgr at Zayo (+30% closed-won). Plus seasonal program management as a PMBIA-certified MTB coach running women's clinics 3x/month — the closest analog I have to managing a seasonal Associate team.
- 3 Boulder local.** Raising a kid here. Not job-hopping to a remote role in 18 months. Invested in the local ecosystem already.

On the venture side — I watched the full venture cycle play out from inside Homebot during the **raise + acquisition**. Not as a partner, but as an early-team operator who sat close enough to the pitch process, due diligence, and close to bring an **operator-first lens** to investment evaluation alongside the MD.

→ engelsted.co/techstars.html

Long-form version of this letter — six-point framework on how I'd run the program, full track record, and the receipts you didn't have room to ask for.

I'd love a coffee. I can be at Foundry on 15 minutes' notice.

Katrina Engelsted

FOUNDER + OPERATOR · BOULDER, CO